

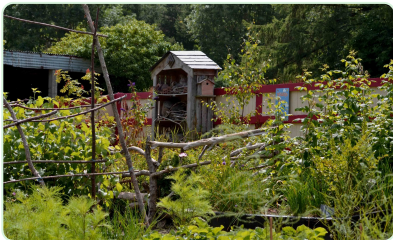
Food Sharing Initiatives (FSIs) in Dublin, Ireland



The Good Grub Initiative
<https://www.goodgrub.ie/>



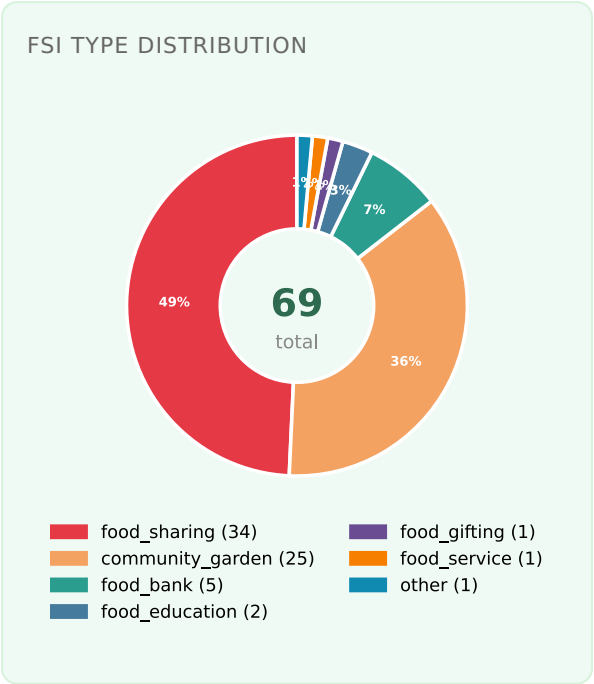
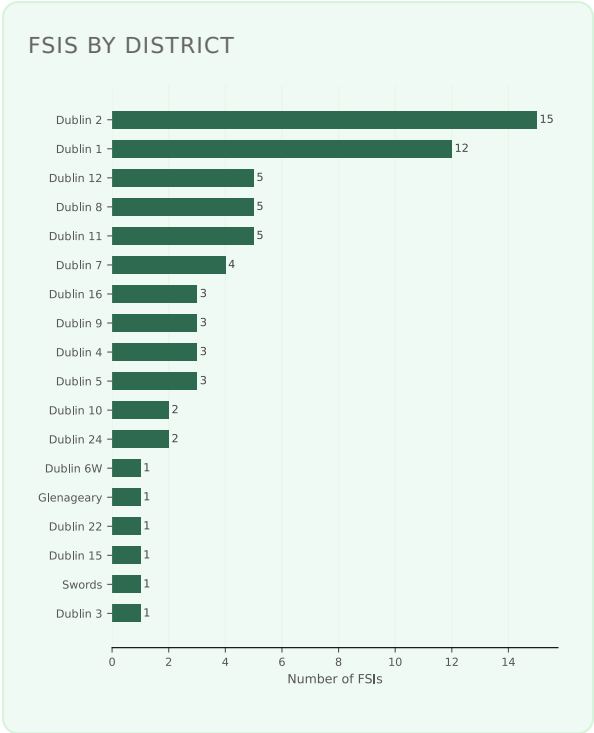
Trinity Care
<https://www.trinitycommunitycare.ie/>



The Importance of School Gardens as a Community
<https://cgireland.org/the-importance-of-school-garden-as-a-community>



Friends of the Elderly Ireland - Bringing friendships and social connections to older adults.
<https://friendsoftheelderly.ie/>



Geographic Distribution

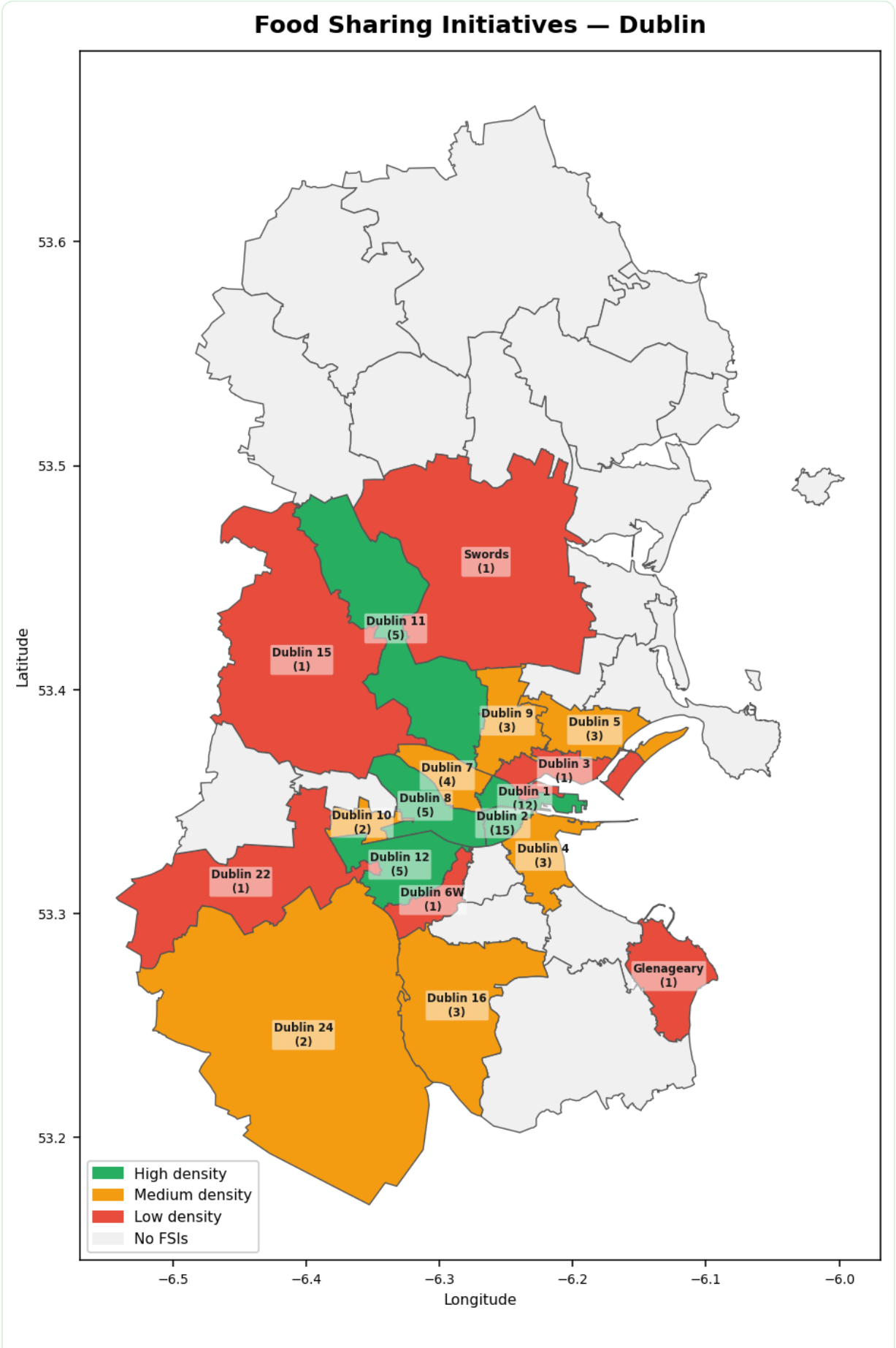


Figure: Food Sharing Initiative locations across Dublin. Districts coloured by FSI density: green = high, yellow = medium, red = low.

Dublin hosts 69 Food Sharing Initiatives (FSIs) across 18 postal districts, with the highest concentration in Dublin 2 (15 FSIs), followed by Dublin 1 (12) and Dublin 12 (5). These three districts account for 34% of all FSIs in the city, reflecting a clear spatial clustering in central and north-eastern areas. Green (high-density) districts—Dublin 2, Dublin 1, Dublin 12, Dublin 8, and Dublin 11—collectively host 42 FSIs, while red (low-density) districts—such as Dublin 6W, Glenageary, and Swords—contain only six FSIs in total, with three of these districts having just one FSI each. This disparity underscores a strong correlation between urban density and FSI prevalence.

Yellow (medium-density) districts, including Dublin 7 (4 FSIs) and Dublin 16 (3 FSIs), exhibit intermediate FSI counts, suggesting a gradient in initiative density from high- to low-density areas. Notably, Dublin 2's 15 FSIs—more than any other district—contrast sharply with the single FSI in Dublin 6W, highlighting uneven resource distribution. The absence of per capita FSI density data limits deeper analysis of equity in access, though the clustering in green districts aligns with patterns observed in other European cities where FSIs thrive in densely populated zones. Dublin 10 (2 FSIs) and Dublin 24 (2 FSIs), both yellow districts, demonstrate that even medium-density areas show variability in FSI presence, potentially influenced by local infrastructure or community engagement.

Types of Food Sharing Initiatives

Dublin hosts 69 Food Sharing Initiatives (FSIs), with the majority (34, or 49.3%) focused on food_sharing, followed by community_gardens (25, or 36.2%). Food_banks constitute 5 (7.2%) of initiatives, while food_education, food_gifting, food_service, and other categories each account for 2.9%, 1.4%, 1.4%, and 1.4% respectively. Of these, 33 FSIs explicitly emphasize sustainability, and 31 incorporate educational components, indicating a strong alignment with broader social and environmental goals. Notably, 37 FSIs organize events or workshops, suggesting active community engagement and outreach efforts.

The distribution of FSIs varies significantly by type, with food_sharing and community_gardens dominating, while food_banks and niche categories remain underrepresented. Sustainability-focused initiatives are more prevalent in food_sharing (22 of 34) and community_gardens (11 of 25) compared to food_banks (3 of 5), reflecting differing priorities across sectors. Educational components are most common in food_education (both initiatives) and food_sharing (18 of 34), but absent in food_gifting and food_service. This contrast highlights divergent operational models, with food_sharing initiatives often combining sustainability, education, and event-based activities, whereas food_banks prioritize direct food distribution over broader engagement. The low representation of food_gifting and food_service (each 1 FSI) underscores limited adoption of these models in Dublin's FSI landscape.

Operational and Funding Models

Dublin hosts 69 Food Sharing Initiatives (FSIs), all of which operate on a non-commercial basis, with no initiatives led by commercial entities or NGOs. The majority (46) are community-led grassroots efforts, while 10 are government-funded and 7 receive council support. Notably, 22 FSIs rely entirely on volunteer labor, and 15 incorporate crowdfunding or donations as funding sources. Only 7 initiatives employ a cooperative model, and 13 are formally registered as NGOs or charities, contrasting with 21 that function informally through community groups.

Community-led initiatives exhibit significant variation in structure, with 21 operating informally and 13 holding formal registration, suggesting differing levels of institutional engagement. The cooperative model, though small in number (7), may indicate a niche approach to collective ownership and decision-making. Volunteer-based FSIs (22) outnumber those using crowdfunding or donations (15), highlighting reliance on unpaid labor over financial contributions. Only 3 FSIs are affiliated with broader food networks, potentially limiting their integration into larger systemic efforts. These disparities underscore the fragmented nature of FSIs, with informal groups dominating in scale but formal entities offering greater structural stability.

Reach and Activity

Dublin hosts 69 Food Sharing Initiatives (FSIs), categorized into 22 high-activity, 20 medium-activity, and 27 low-activity groups, reflecting a broad spectrum of operational scales. Collectively, these initiatives reference 1,718 units of food redistributed, encompassing meals, kilograms of produce, and member contributions, indicating a measurable but uneven impact across the city. Notably, 28 FSIs collaborate with farms, restaurants, or stores, suggesting a significant portion of initiatives integrate supply chain partnerships to source surplus food. This collaboration may enhance efficiency but also highlights disparities in resource access among different FSI groups.

Among target audiences, 43 FSIs focus on elderly individuals, the largest single group, while 42 initiatives aim at the general public, underscoring a strong emphasis on broad community engagement. In contrast, only 7 FSIs specifically target low-income populations, and 15 focus on students, revealing a gap in addressing food insecurity among economically vulnerable groups. The high number of initiatives targeting the elderly and general public may reflect broader outreach strategies, whereas the smaller focus on low-income and student groups could indicate underrepresentation of these needs in current FSI frameworks. These patterns suggest that while FSIs in Dublin demonstrate diverse engagement, their impact on marginalized populations remains limited compared to their reach among more general or elderly demographics.

Digital Presence and Accessibility

All 69 Food Sharing Initiatives (FSIs) in Dublin maintain a digital presence, as evidenced by website data, indicating a strong reliance on online platforms for communication and

coordination. Of these, 27 FSIs explicitly mention online or digital coordination methods, suggesting a subset prioritizes virtual engagement, while 39 operate from physical locations, highlighting the coexistence of hybrid models. Only 4 FSIs provide detailed operating hours or frequency information, a minimal proportion that may limit transparency for potential participants. The absence of consistent accessibility features across FSI websites represents a significant data gap, potentially excluding individuals with disabilities or limited digital literacy from accessing these initiatives.

Comparing sub-groups, FSIs with online coordination (27) may cater to broader audiences through virtual platforms, whereas those relying solely on physical locations (39) might serve more localized communities. The lack of operating hours details for 94% of FSIs (65 out of 69) could hinder participation for individuals requiring predictable schedules, such as students or shift workers. Notably, the absence of standardized accessibility information across websites implies uneven support for diverse user needs, despite all FSIs having digital presence. This contrast between digital availability and functional accessibility underscores a critical challenge in ensuring equitable access to food sharing resources in Dublin.

Notable Initiatives

Dublin hosts 69 Food Sharing Initiatives (FSIs) in total, with Dublin 2, Dublin 1, and Dublin 12 accounting for the highest concentrations, at 15, 12, and 5 FSIs respectively. These districts collectively represent 37% of all FSIs in the dataset, indicating a strong regional focus on food redistribution and community engagement. Notably, 31 of the 69 FSIs incorporate educational components, such as workshops or school programs, while 37 organize events like food drives or cooking demonstrations, highlighting the dual emphasis on practical action and public awareness. The 22 FSIs classified as high-popularity operate in multiple districts, suggesting broader reach and collaboration across urban areas.

Dublin 2's 15 FSIs include a disproportionately high number of event-organizing initiatives compared to other districts, with 11 of its FSIs actively hosting events, whereas Dublin 12's 5 FSIs include only 2 event organizers. This contrast underscores varying operational priorities, with Dublin 2 emphasizing community engagement through frequent activities. Meanwhile, Dublin 1's 12 FSIs show a balanced mix of educational and event-based initiatives, with 7 incorporating educational components, compared to Dublin 2's 9 educational FSIs. The data also reveals that 45% of all FSIs (31 out of 69) focus on education, a figure significantly higher than the 54% (37 out of 69) that organize events, suggesting a stronger institutional commitment to long-term awareness over immediate action.